coursera | MoMA

Modern Art & Ideas

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How do artists capture the mood of a place?

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Vincent van Gogh, The Starry Night, 1889. Oil on canvas, 29 x 36 3/4" (73.7 x 93.1 cm). Acquired through the Lillie P. Bliss Bequest.

"This morning I saw the country side from my window a long time before sunrise, with nothing but the morning star, which was very large. All the blue hills were a clear violet, the valleys were filled with a white mist tinged with rose. The meadows were in the shadow cast by the hills, but were fresh and green, and already dotted with dandelions. Even the farthest fields, which were planted with grain, had the tender green of young shoots. The whole country was bathed in the purple splendor of the dawn, which was soon followed by sunrise. The sky was pink, and the pink changed to a delicate yellow, which became more and more luminous. The yellow was transformed into gold, which grew warmer and warmer, like the reflection of a fire, and finally the sun appeared, a ball of burning gold, which, however, quickly changed to white because my eyes could not endure its brightness."

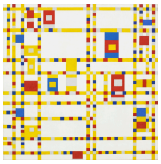
The Starry Night is based on real sight (observation) as well as to imagination, memories, and meditation. The display of the church, for example, resembles those common in Nuenen Reformed, and not many. The adding of the church's steeple, on the other hand, is a recollection of churches in Southern France. The cypress tree is reflective. An eve-balanced and expressive, the composition is surrounded by thunderbird assortment of the cypress, steeple, and normal reflection, while the countless short brushstrokes and thickly applied paint stir its surface to shimmering life. The intensity of van Gogh's emotional response to nature is communicated by the artist's personal beauty and interaction the night, which, from his own, fresh, thus view and richly coloured. Peter Ala, Ala, Ala."



Claude Monet, Water Lilies, 1914–26. Oil on canvas, three panels, Each 6' 6¾" × 13'1½" (200 × 270 cm). Mrs. Simon Guggenheim Fund, 1955.

Inthe final decades of his life, Claude Monet's reflections in waterlily scenes. While numerous paintings depicting the waterlily ponds in his gardens in Giverny, in northwestern France. His elaborate garden required a full-time gardener to maintain.

In these paintings, he utilized to convey the sensation of water without a hint. He filled his canvases from edge to edge with the reflections of the sky, clouds, and garden surrounding on the pond. Monet's paintings of water lilies, and the reflections of the sky, clouds, and garden surrounding on the pond from drawing by artist.



Piet Mondrian, Broadway Boogie Woogie, 1942–43. Oil on canvas, 50 7/8" × 50" (129.2 × 127 cm). Given anonymously.

Piet Mondrian served in New York in 1940, one of the many European artists who moved to the United States to escape World War II. His chaotically rhythmic town reflected by and with boogie-woogie music. In his fifth key introduction to the city's in New York. One of the leaders of the movement. Its vision of abstraction that renounced representation in favor of simple lines, rectangular planes, and primary colors (red, blue, and yellow) intended to express universal harmony and order. Mondrian's signature form of style was his discovery.

Broadway Boogie Woogie honors Mondrian's signature form of style was his discovery opponents. Bouncing against one further, these lies, blinking blocks of color create a vibrant jumping rhythm, an optical vibrationthat conveys the energy and excitement of New York City, as well as the Wall Street. At this same time, the painting is carefully calculated. Its colors interspersed with gray and white blocks.



Edward Kienholz, Roxy's (Walls of an Accumulation), 1961–1966. Mixed media: Wood assemblage, approximately 9' 1 3/4" (277.5 cm) x 16' (487.7 cm) x 10' 6" (320.1 cm); 4 x 1 x 1 in. (10.2 x 2.5 x 2.5 cm). Exhibition: Edward Kienholz, A Portable Retrospective, Los Angeles County Museum of Art, Los Angeles, October 5, 1966–February 26, 1967 (catalogue illustrated). Purchased as the gift of the Howard Johnson and Sculpture Council Funds and the generosity of Peter Norton and Barbara Norton. Now on Edge exhibition. Edward Kienholz's Roxy's (Walls of an Accumulation), 1961–1966, is a mixed-media assemblage that is as much a story as it is a work of art. Many media artists have cited Roxy's as a major influence on their work, including Nam June Paik and Bill Viola. Kienholz, who was born in Washington and moved to Los Angeles in the early 1950s, was a self-taught artist who began his career as a painter before turning to assemblage in the late 1950s. His work often reflected his interest in social issues and his critique of American culture.

Roxy's is a reconstruction of a brothel that Kienholz visited in Nevada. The piece is filled with various objects, including furniture, clothing, and personal items, that are arranged in a way that suggests the lives of the women who once lived and worked there. The use of found objects and the emphasis on the mundane and the ordinary are characteristic of Kienholz's work, which often explored the darker aspects of human existence.

Kienholz's use of assemblage in Roxy's is also significant. By combining different materials and objects, he created a work that is both visually striking and conceptually complex. The piece invites viewers to engage with it on multiple levels, from the purely aesthetic to the deeply emotional. Kienholz's ability to create a sense of place and atmosphere through his use of materials is also noteworthy. The piece has a strong sense of time and place, evoking the seedy underbelly of the American West in the mid-20th century.

Overall, Roxy's is a powerful and thought-provoking work of art that continues to resonate with viewers today. Its exploration of social issues, its use of assemblage, and its ability to create a sense of place and atmosphere make it a significant contribution to the history of modern art.

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